ENERGY WATCH

POLESTAR INSIGHTS

REPORTING PERIOD: 17 MAY 2026 - 23 MAY 2026

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Grid risk this week is a reliability-and-continuity story rather than a single dramatic failure. The pressure came from power outage, power tariff / pricing and load shedding. Indonesia carried the most visible grid strain, alongside Philippines and Pakistan. The most serious reached moderate.

Behind the individual events sits the structural picture: thin generation margins, ageing transmission and a heavy dependence on fuel-to-power supply that turns a hot afternoon or a tripped substation into hours of lost load. Outages, load shedding and shortfall are the symptoms; the underlying weakness is a grid with little room to absorb a shock.

For business users the implication is operational, not abstract: unplanned downtime, generator hours and the running cost of keeping critical sites lit. Backup power, fuel cover for extended outages and a clear view of single-source grid dependence are the measures that earn their keep while this picture holds.

FAST FACTS

REPORTING PERIOD **17 May - 23 May 2026**	TOTAL RECORDS **11** Energy this period	HIGHEST SEVERITY **Moderate** Highest rating this period
TOP ISSUE TYPE **Power outage** 6 records	MOST AFFECTED COUNTRY **Indonesia** 3 records	LATEST INCIDENT **23 May 2026**

MARKET PRICES

ELECTRICITY (US CITY AVG)
US city average retail electricity

0.198 USD/kWh
+1.0% MoM

As of Jun 2026 · BLS / FRED (APU000072610)

NATURAL GAS (EUROPE)
EU import natural gas

15.09 USD/MMBtu
-6.6% MoM

As of Jun 2026 · IMF / FRED (PNGASEUUSDM)

NATURAL GAS (HENRY HUB)
Henry Hub natural gas spot

2.810 USD/MMBtu
+6.8% 7d

As of 03 Aug 2026 · EIA / FRED (DHHNGSP)

THERMAL COAL (AUSTRALIA)
Australian thermal coal

150.36 USD/mt
+6.3% MoM

As of Jun 2026 · IMF / FRED (PCOALAUUSDM)

SITUATION

Capacity margins stay thin and fuel-to-power supply remains the underlying weakness, so the grid has little headroom when demand peaks or a feeder trips. This matters because reliability and cost move together here: every hour of lost load is both a continuity problem and a generator-fuel bill, and long restorations turn a brief dip into real operational disruption. Indonesia sits at the centre of the current reporting.

WHAT HAPPENED

Reporting centred on power outage, power tariff / pricing and load shedding. Reporting concentrated on Indonesia, with more from Philippines and Pakistan. The most serious reached moderate.

WHAT MATTERS

Reliability gaps land first on site uptime and generator load, then on the running cost of business continuity. When outages run long the cost shifts from inconvenience to fuel burn, spoiled stock, missed production and overtime to recover. Exposure to Indonesia is the live pressure point for backup power, generator fuel and continuity spend.

Where weak generation margins meet a transmission fault or a fuel-supply squeeze, the impact compounds: load shedding deepens, restoration slows, and sites on a single grid feed lose the buffer they assumed they had. That is the exposure worth planning against now, rather than after the next peak-demand failure.

IMPLICATIONS FOR BUSINESS

- Check backup generator cover and service status against a multi-hour outage, not just a brief dip.
- Hold fuel stock for extended generator runtime wherever the public grid is the only feed.
- Confirm UPS run-time and failover on critical loads - servers, cold chain, life-safety and security systems.
- Map single-source dependence on the public grid and line up alternate supply or on-site generation before the next peak.
- Build outage cost into continuity budgets - fuel burn, spoilage, lost production and recovery overtime add up fast on long restorations.

WATCH NEXT

- Load-shedding schedules - fresh rationing notices are the clearest sign generation margins are tightening.
- Substation and transmission faults - repeat trips on the same network point to ageing infrastructure, not one-off events.
- Fuel-to-power supply - gas, diesel and coal availability decides whether plants can actually run to capacity.

- Peak-demand weather - heatwaves and cold snaps push demand past the margin and trigger shedding.
- Generation outages and maintenance - planned and forced unit outages tighten the supply buffer within days.

POLESTAR VIEW

Energy Watch is flagging standing grid fragility rather than a single dramatic failure. The risk is structural - thin generation margins and heavy fuel-to-power dependence - so the operational answer is resilience: backup power, fuel cover and a clear view of single-grid dependence. Indonesia is the clearest country pressure point, with the rest of the picture filled in by Philippines and Pakistan.

RELATED INCIDENTS

DATE	TYPE	TITLE	SEVERITY
23 May 2026	Power outage	PLN Chief Apologizes After Major Sumatra Power Outage Power outage, reported 23 May 2026, assessed at Moderate severity.	MODERATE
23 May 2026	Power outage	Power blackout hits northern Sumatra, restoration underway Power outage, reported 23 May 2026, assessed at Moderate severity.	MODERATE
23 May 2026	Power outage	Gurugram power outage: What caused massive blackout on Friday - from oil leakage in transformer to blast Power outage, reported 23 May 2026, assessed at Moderate severity.	MODERATE
22 May 2026	Power outage	Major Blackout Hits Parts of Sumatra, Indonesia Power outage, reported 22 May 2026, assessed at Moderate severity.	MODERATE
22 May 2026	Power tariff / pricing	New power tariff may raise bills for homes using over 400 units from July - Nation Thailand Power tariff / pricing, reported 22 May 2026, assessed at Low severity.	LOW
21 May 2026	Power outage	Power outages up in Visayas due to manual load dropping Power outage, reported 21 May 2026, assessed at Low severity.	LOW
21 May 2026	Power tariff / pricing	Govt. will not seek electricity tariff hike until September Power tariff / pricing, reported 21 May 2026, assessed at Low severity.	LOW
20 May 2026	Load shedding	Power generation hits record 17,200MW amid 400MW load-shedding Load shedding, reported 20 May 2026, assessed at Low severity.	LOW
20 May 2026	Fuel-to-power disruption	Power tariff likely to rise by Rs1.72/unit under April FCA Fuel-to-power disruption, reported 20 May 2026, assessed at Low severity.	LOW
19 May 2026	Power tariff / pricing	Electricity prices may drop by Rs1.93 per unit Power tariff / pricing, reported 19 May 2026, assessed at Low severity.	LOW

DISCLAIMER